

SEALED SOLUTION

Stop here until you commit.

This file reveals the investigation, the identities, and the ending. Keep it separate from the player packet.

Before continuing, write your conclusion, cite the records that support it, and name an uncertainty the file does not resolve.

Read the evidence-cited solution first. The expanded aftermath follows the original ending. It develops the human consequences; it does not supply a clue needed to solve the case.

A blank reverse follows this cover so the first answer starts on a fresh sheet when this file is printed on both sides.

SPOILER BARRIER

The answer is overleaf.

Keep this file closed until your written reconstruction is complete.

The family reconstructed

1 / ELLEN BYRNE AND FRANCIS HART

Samuel married Ellen Byrne on 14 September 1876 (EH03). EH04 names Samuel and Ellen as parents of Francis Hart, born 3 July 1877. Ellen died on 4 November 1879. Samuel married Margaret Cole on 19 May 1881 (EH03). Samuel's M2 and Margaret's M1 in EH02 fit this sequence.

2 / FRANK IS FRANCIS, ELEANOR'S HALF-BROTHER

Francis is Michael Byrne's two-year-old nephew in 1880 (EH05). In 1900, a nephew called Frank Byrne, born July 1877, lives with the same adults at 204 Kilgour Street (EH06). EH07 explicitly identifies him as the same boy, Samuel's son by Michael's sister Ellen. EH04 establishes that Michael is Ellen's brother. The census matches support the connection; the letter confirms it.

EH11 links the adult Frank in 1912 to the same Cincinnati address. Frank and Eleanor share Samuel as father but have different mothers. Michael and Catherine raised Frank; these records do not require a legal adoption.

3 / FRANK FITS THE GIFT IN THE WILL

The gift is to Samuel's eldest surviving son, with no requirement to work at the business or live in his household (EH08). Frank was born in 1877 and is alive in 1912 (EH04, EH11). James was twenty in 1910 (EH02), so is younger. On these records Frank is the eldest surviving son.

George believed the first child had died because Samuel told him so. His memorandum reports that belief; it does not prove the death. The works have not yet been delivered. George should stop the acknowledgment and verify Eleanor's records (EH08).

Complete answers identify the people, explain the name change, and apply the actual will wording. Matching surnames or running the works is insufficient.

Why Eleanor did not return

4 / JAMES HART

The supported reconstruction is that James took Eleanor to the lower store to look for Samuel's receipt book, stepped outside, and deliberately locked her in. He wanted to keep her from presenting the family evidence before George signed the acknowledgment.

Part of the case	Evidence
Immediate pressure	EH10: \$1,200 due 20 June. James cannot repay in cash and promises Wednesday's acknowledgment. EH08: Frank's existence threatens James's expected ownership.
Arranged meeting	EH09: James asks Eleanor to come alone at five for the receipt book. Eleanor plans supper at six and disclosure the next morning. EH01 independently records her supper plan.
Access and conduct	EH12: James takes C7 at 4.50 and does not return it. EH13: he comes up the lower stairs alone at about 5.20, says Eleanor left, and tells Vale not to try the store.
Deliberate confinement	EH15: the door locks only with a key and has no inside release. EH16: Eleanor heard the key and was told she would stay until the acknowledgment was signed.

Other explanations: EH11 places Frank under continuous supervision in Pittsburgh. EH12 places George with Ada Pike and Henry unloading elsewhere during 5.10-5.20. These weaken alternatives; the positive evidence against James carries the conclusion.

The watchman did not identify the descending man. Do not turn that uncertainty into an eyewitness identification. His later recognition of James is explicit.

The message and the room

5 / JAMES ARRANGED THE TELEGRAM

EH14 says Paul Finch received the envelope directly from James at 7.30 p.m. The enclosed charge instruction used J17, which EH12 identifies as James's private account. The office copied the supplied signature and did not see Eleanor.

That proves James arranged dispatch. The signature does not establish Eleanor's authorship or consent. Acceptance in Cincinnati does not, by itself, disprove a plan to travel to Dayton. Read with her intended return (EH09) and note from confinement (EH16), the telegram supports the attempt to make her disappearance appear voluntary.

6 / SEARCH THE FORMER PATTERN STORE

Go to **418 Eastern Avenue, Hart Tool & Pattern Works**. Take the internal stair and passage to the lower store, formerly the pattern store. Use **C7** or the duplicate in the **sealed envelope in the office cash box** (EH12, EH15).

The narrow east-yard grille, pearwood shelving and internal route identify the room (EH09, EH15, EH16). There is no route from that room to the river gate and no other exit. The lock requires a key, so an accidental closing cannot explain the confinement (EH15).

Eleanor's note, identified by Margaret as her writing, says she survived the night and saw morning (EH16). Repeated knocking at 8.10 a.m. supports an immediate search (EH13). Opening the door is required to confirm her present condition.

Complete search answer: address + room + internal route + C7 duplicate + deliberate locking + morning evidence.

The sequence that fits

When	What the records support
17 June	George agrees to hear Eleanor before distribution. James tells the lender he expects the acknowledgment on Wednesday. EH08-EH10.
18 June / 4.00-5.00	James arranges the solitary visit. Eleanor leaves home at about 4.30, intending supper at six. James takes C7 at 4.50. EH01, EH09, EH12.
5.10-5.20	Vale sees a woman matching Eleanor descend with a man. James comes up alone at about 5.20 and tells him the lower store is empty. Confinement during this interval is the reconstruction. EH13, EH16.
6.30	Vale hears repeated knocks but accepts the explanation that no one is below. EH13.
7.30-8.12	James gives Finch the message; the office accepts it at 7.48 and delivers it at 8.12. EH14.
19 June / 7.50-8.15	The duplicate seal is checked. The attendance reply arrives. Vale hears knocking, finds the door locked and then finds Eleanor's note. EH11-EH13, EH16.
Before 10.00	Stop the acknowledgment. Open the lower store with the duplicate. Verify the family evidence before proceeding with the estate. EH08, EH12, EH15-EH16.

The exact moment the key turned is inferred from the combined evidence, not supplied as a witnessed timestamp.

A place for one more

George broke the seal on the envelope himself. Ada Pike watched him take out the duplicate key, then followed him to the stair.

At the lower door, he called Eleanor's name. The answer was so faint that he put his ear to the iron before he tried the lock.

She was sitting beside the shelves, her portfolio on her knees. The blue tape had been tied again. There was dust on her skirt and a carpenter's pencil in her hand. She asked whether he had signed.

He said he had not.

James had brought her down to find the receipts. When she bent over the books, he stepped outside and turned the key. Through the door he told her it would only be until morning. Once George had signed, he said, there would be no purpose in upsetting everyone.

"He told me I could still have a brother," she said. "He meant I should choose which one."

The police found the working key in James's coat. The meeting did not take place. George retained the estate papers for examination, and Margaret took Eleanor home.

Two days later, Frank Byrne came to Lincoln Avenue. He stood on the step with his hat in both hands, as though he had called at a customer's house.

Eleanor opened the door. She had thought of several things to say and remembered none of them. From the dining room her mother asked whether their guest would stay for supper.

"There is a place," Eleanor told him.

AFTER THE CASE

The chair was only a beginning

After the original solution and ending

At supper, Frank did not take Samuel's chair. Nobody had asked him to, but Margaret noticed the care with which he chose another.

She had imagined this meeting as an arrival: open the door, set another place, and the exclusion would at last be over. Instead she found herself wondering whether to pass him the bread before Henry, whether using Francis would sound intimate or merely ignorant, whether an apology would ask a guest to comfort his hosts.

Eleanor had been rescued. That fact deserved all the relief the house could hold. It did not make the other facts easier. James was still her son. Frank was still a stranger to her. Samuel, who had arranged so much of their ignorance, could answer none of their questions.

"Michael calls me Frank," their guest said when George hesitated over his name.

Margaret was grateful for the instruction. "Frank, then."

Henry asked about the practical examination. It was a real question, about work he wanted to understand, and Frank answered it. For a few minutes nobody needed to discuss the estate. Eleanor listened with her hands below the edge of the table. When a door sounded in the passage, she looked up too quickly. Her mother saw it and kept her own hands still.

Later, George spoke of checking the originals. He said plainly that the works had not been delivered to James. He did not ask Frank to admire his caution now, after the years in which he had believed Samuel's account.

"I should have checked what I was told," he said.

Frank regarded him for a moment. "You can check it now."

It was less than forgiveness and more useful than reassurance.

When Margaret began, "If we had known," Eleanor touched the folded napkin beside her plate. Her mother stopped. She had almost offered an impossible history in place of the evening they actually had.

"I don't know what you would like us to call this," Margaret said instead.

"Supper," Frank answered. There was a small kindness in it, and a boundary.

After he had gone, Eleanor refused to have her portfolio put away in Samuel's desk. She asked for it in her own room. Margaret carried it upstairs and left it where her daughter could reach it.

The investigation had established the relationship, the confinement, the false message, and the place to search. It had not established that a new brother could replace an old one, or that a meal could repay thirty-four years. George still had papers to examine. The family had something smaller for this evening: the right names spoken aloud, and an invitation that had finally been made.